

ENTRANCE ANTIPHON

Within your will, O Lord, all things are established, and there is none that can resist your will. For you have made all things, the heaven and the earth, and all that is held within the circle of heaven; you are the Lord of all.

PENITENTIAL ACT

Have mercy on us, O Lord.

For we have sinned against you.

Show us, O Lord, your mercy.

And grant us your salvation.

May almighty God have mercy on us,.....Amen.

Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy.

Christ, have mercy. Christ, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy.

THE GLORIA

Glory to God in the highest,
and on earth peace to people of good will.

We praise you, we bless you,

we adore you, we glorify you,

we give you thanks for your great glory,

Lord God, heavenly King,

O God, almighty Father.

Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,

Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father

you take away the sins of the world:

have mercy on us;

you take away the sins of the world,

receive our prayer; you are seated

at the right hand of the Father

have mercy on us;

For you alone are the Holy One,

you alone are the Lord,

you alone are the Most High,

Jesus Christ, with the Holy Spirit,

in the glory of God the Father. Amen.

OPENING PRAYER

Almighty ever-living God, who in the abundance of your kindness surpass the merits and the desires of those who entreat you, pour out your mercy upon us to pardon what conscience dreads and to give what prayer does not dare to ask.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ.....

LITURGY OF THE WORD**FIRST READING Isaiah 5: 1 - 7**

A reading from the prophet Isaiah

Let me sing to my friend

the song of his love for his vineyard.

My friend had a vineyard on a fertile hillside.

He dug the soil, cleared it of stones,

and planted choice vines in it.

In the middle he built a tower,

he dug a press there too.

He expected it to yield grapes,

but sour grapes were all that it gave.

And now, inhabitants of Jerusalem

and men of Judah, I ask you to judge

between my vineyard and me.

What could I have done for my vineyard

that I have not done?

I expected it to yield grapes.



Why did it yield sour grapes instead?

Very well, I will tell you

what I am going to do to my vineyard:

I will take away its hedge for it to be grazed on,

and knock down its wall for it to be trampled on.

I will lay it waste, unpruned, undug;

overgrown by the briar and the thorn.

I will command the clouds to rain no rain on it.

Yes, the vineyard of the Lord of hosts

is the House of Israel, and the men on

Judah that chosen plant.

He expected justice, but found bloodshed,

integrity, but only a cry of distress.

The word of the Lord. Thanks be to God.

RESPONSORIAL PSALM Ps. 79:9, 12-16, 19-20

R. The vineyard of the Lord is the House of Israel.

1. You brought a vine out of Egypt;
to plant it you drove out the nations.
It stretched out its branches to the sea,
to the Great River it stretched out its shoots. (R)

2. Then why have you broken down its walls?
It is plucked by all who pass by.
It is ravaged by the boar of the forest,
devoured by the beasts of the field. (R)

3. God of hosts, turn again, we implore,
look down from heaven and see.
Visit this vine and protect it,
the vine your right hand has planted. (R)

4. And we shall never forsake you again:
give us life that we may call upon your name.
God of hosts, bring us back;
let your face shine on us and we shall
be saved. (R)

SECOND READING Philippians 4: 6 - 9

A reading from the letter of St Paul to the Philippians

There is no need to worry; but if there is anything you need, pray for it, asking God for it with prayer and thanksgiving, and that peace of God, which is so much greater than we can understand, will guard your hearts and your thoughts, in Christ Jesus. Finally, brothers, fill your minds with everything that is true, everything that is noble, everything that is good and pure, everything that we love and honour, and everything that can be thought virtuous or worthy of praise. Keep doing all the things that you learnt from me and have been taught by me and have heard or seen that I do. Then the God of peace will be with you.

The word of the Lord. Thanks be to God.

GOSPEL ACCLAMATION

Alleluia, alleluia! I choose you from the world to go out and bear fruit, fruit that will last, says the Lord. Alleluia!

GOSPEL Matthew 21: 33 - 43

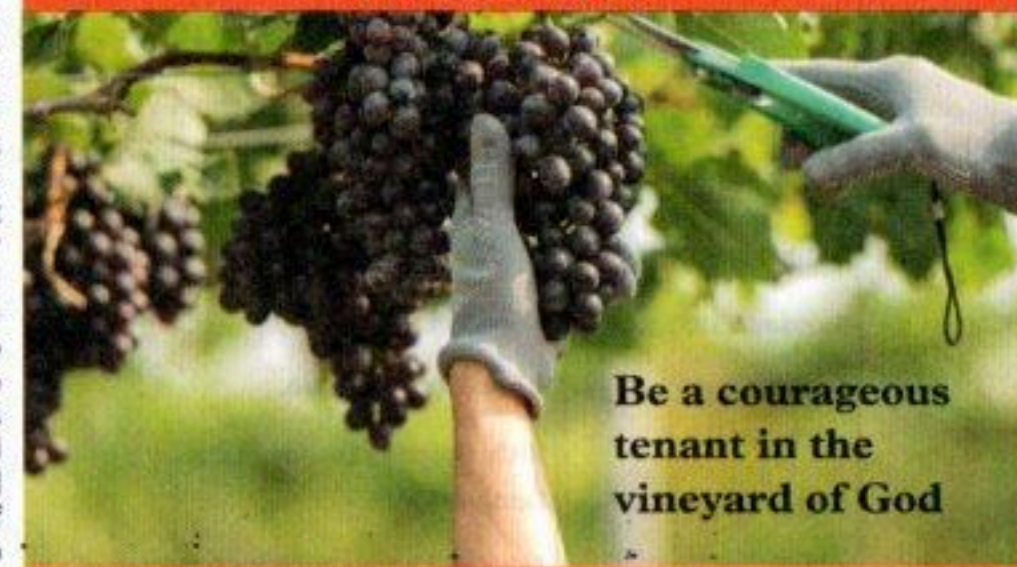
A reading from the holy Gospel according to Matthew

Jesus said to the chief priests and the elders of the people, 'Listen to another parable. There was a man, a landowner, who planted a vineyard; he

**focus on sunday**

TWENTY-SEVENTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME 4th October 2026 Year A

The graces and gifts which God gives to us are both signs to us of his love and his care, and also his expectation that they will bear fruit in our lives.



Be a courageous tenant in the vineyard of God



Jesus is in the Temple, addressing the chief priests and elders who are questioning his authority. With his parable of the wicked tenants, he issues a rebuke and a challenge to these religious leaders who believe they alone have

authority. The tenants in the parable are not fulfilling their responsibilities; instead of tending the vineyard entrusted to them, they are only looking after themselves. If we think of the vineyard as our world, this parable jumps into the modern age. Humanity has been entrusted with this beautiful and bountiful world. But instead of caring for it and sharing its fruits, those in power exploit it for their own benefit. We are called to care for this precious vineyard, Earth, our common home. This involves spiritual conversion and action.

Today we mark the end of the Season of Creation by celebrating the Feast of St Francis of Assisi. St Francis lived in harmony with creation, with a sense of wonder and praise for God's gift of life and the gift of creation. As well as helping the poor and sick, he cared deeply about all creatures on Earth, often preaching about animals and calling them 'brother' and 'sister', and inviting flowers to "praise the Lord". St Francis embraced a deep integral ecology, aware of just how deeply interconnected everything is. He showed us that care for creation is inseparable from justice for the poor and interior peace. He lived out this integral ecology joyfully, with an open heart. St Francis takes us to the heart of what it is to be human and invites us to profound interior conversion. He challenges us to "see nature as a magnificent book in which God speaks to us and grants us a glimpse of his infinite beauty and goodness" (Laudato Si', §12).

We are called into this awareness so that we can begin to repair our broken relationship with the natural world, turn away from destruction and, feeling intimately connected to all that exists, care more deeply for our common home, this vineyard. The natural beauty and diversity of our planet call us into a deeper communion with the Earth and with God.

Jane Mellett & Triona Doherty. Adapted from *The Deep End – A Journey through the Sunday Gospels in the Year of Matthew*, Messenger Publications, Dublin, 2022.

It was the stone rejected by the builders
that became the keystone.
This was the Lord's doing
and it is wonderful to see?

'I tell you, then, that the kingdom of God will be taken from you and given to a people that will produce its fruit.'

The Gospel of the Lord.

Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

Pray brothers and sisters,

May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands for the praise and glory of his name, for our good and the good of all his holy Church.

AFTER THE CONSECRATION

The mystery of faith.

**Save us, Saviour of the world,
for by your Cross and Resurrection
you have set us free.**

PARISH CENTRE: 22229/22779; CATHEDRAL PRESBYTERY: 22505

BÓTHAR NA NAOMH PRESBYTERY: 22688.

PARISH CENTRE MOBILE NUMBER: 085 8819575

WEBSITE: www.thurlesparish.ie **email:** parishcentre@thurlesparish.ie

THURLES PARISH MASS TIMES:

WEEKENDS: Cathedral: Saturday Vigil 7.00 p.m., Sunday 11.00 a.m.

Bóthar na Naomh Church: Sunday 09.30 a.m. & 7.00 p.m.

WEEKDAYS: Cathedral: Monday - Friday: 11.00 a.m.

Bóthar na Naomh: Tuesday & Thursday 7.00 p.m. Saturday: 11.00 a.m.

FOR OUR STREAMING SERVICE ON-LINE visit www.thurlesparish.ie.

CATHEDRAL OF THE ASSUMPTION: "RAISE THE ROOF"

LOTTO INITIATIVE

Weekly Lotto Draw Results Oct 8th:

Winning Numbers 4; 7; 8; 12. The Jackpot was not won.

Cash Prize of €50 to the weekly winner – John O'Donovan, Thurles.

Next Draw: October 15th - Jackpot: €11,350.

We are deeply grateful to all who have supported to date our fundraising drive for the Cathedral Reroofing Project -- We are delighted to inform you that we now have exceeded 1.8 million!! A big Mile Buíochas to all who are supporting this project.

The lotto has assisted immensely in reaching the €1.8 million of the €2.5 million required for us to commence the Reroofing of our Cathedral. Thank you!!

'IN OUR HANDS: PRESERVING OUR CATHEDRAL'

Having now commenced Phase 2 of our fundraising campaign which we hope will get us to the magic figure of €2.5 million. *"In Our Hands: Preserving Our Cathedral"* is a fundraising campaign that we hope will encourage people, near and far, to support the reroofing project by donating towards the cost of the slates. Our objective is to have all the necessary works to this magnificent building completed in time for the 150th anniversary of the Cathedral's construction in 2029. You can purchase a slate or a bundle of 4 – a symbolic and practical way to help reroof the Cathedral. *Let us preserve our sacred Cathedral, protect its rich history and ensure it continues to inspire for generations to come! Visit www.inourhandsthurles.ie for more information.*

WEEKLY ENVELOPE CONTRIBUTION: We are very grateful for your Weekly Offertory Contributions - €3,640.00 received.

OCTOBER CLERGY COLLECTION: Sincere thanks to all who contributed to this Collection last weekend. Jim & Vincent say *"thank you"* for your continued support on behalf of the Priests of the Archdiocese.

FAMILY MASS: First Family Mass for the new year - Sat 10th Oct @ 7.00 p.m. in the Cathedral. Theme: All are invited!

THE CHOSEN: Join us for Season 5 of the award-winning mini-series on the life of Jesus. Season 5 documents the events of Easter Week and especially the Last Supper. A great opportunity to deepen your faith with time for prayer and conversation. Come along and join us in Lámh Chúnta, Monday October 12th at 7.30 p.m.

THURLES YOUNG ADULT PRAYER: See the upcoming dates for our prayer group (open to 18-35 year olds) which meets in Bóthar na Naomh Church twice a month on Fridays @ 8pm. Prayer, Adoration, Scripture and friendship with other young people interested in their faith. All are welcome.

ADORATION FOR YOUTH: Tuesday Oct. 20th in Bóthar na Naomh Church commencing with Mass at 7.00 pm. Followed by Adoration until 10 p.m. Come and pray for this intention.

MISSION SUNDAY 11.00 A.M. MASS:

The 11.00 a.m. Mass on Mission Sunday, October 18th will be broadcast live by R.T.E. in the Cathedral. Archbishop Kieran O'Reilly will celebrate the Mass. Come along and join us in the Cathedral on Mission Sunday.

Annual Missions Collection Envelopes available at the back of both Churches.

Please Note: Due to preparation for the Mission Sunday Mass there will be NO EUCHARISTIC ADORATION on Saturday, October 17th.

POPE JOHN PAUL II AWARD - CALLING ALL 16-18-YEAR-OLDS: Get active, get involved and make a difference in your local parish and school community through the **Pope John Paul II Award**. This is a wonderful opportunity to meet others, develop your skills and put your faith into action. To find out more or take part locally, contact your parish priest or Fiona, Youth Coordinator, at youth@cashesmly.ie. Applications close on **31 October**.

GOD WITH ST. FRANCIS: Evening of faith, music and reflection inspired by the life of St. Francis of Assisi on Friday 16th October at 7.30 pm in St Michael's Church, Tipperary Town. Through Scripture, prayer, reflection and Christian music, the parish with **James Kilbane, Gospel Singer**, will help lead this special parish evening. Free parish service with a free will offering collection to help with expenses. All welcome.

URSULINE SECONDARY SCHOOL: Presents Les Misérables. Saturday, October 17, Sunday, October 18, Tuesday, October 20 & Thursday, October 22 - nightly at 8pm. Tickets on Gr8events.ie

ONE FLEW OVER THE CUCKOO'S NEST: Thurles Drama Group are staging One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest in The Source Theatre commencing on **Monday 16th November**. The proceeds from the first night of the production on Monday, 16th November are being donated to Thurles Lions Club who have committed to raising a minimum of €50,000 towards the Cathedral of the Assumption Reroofing Fund. Tickets are €20 each and include a pre-show finger food reception at 7.15 pm. Tickets available from The Parish Office or Thurles Lions Club members.

PREVENTION & MANAGEMENT OF LYMPHOEDEMA: Suir Haven Cancer Support Centre, Monday 12th Oct., 6.30pm All are welcome. Information: Tricia on 0876509494.

THURLES DISTRICT FLOWER CLUB: Next Meeting Tuesday, October 13th, Order of Malta Hall, 8.00 p.m. Garden Talk by Niall Tuohy, Ardmayle. Non-members welcome. Admission: €10 including refreshments.

CIRCLING THE SQUARE POETRY FESTIVAL: October 16th – 18th. **Fri. 7.30p.m. Bookworm:** Opening & poetry. **Sat. 2.30 p.m. Source Arts Centre:** Panel with **Fintan O'Toole, Declan O'Driscoll & Mick Heaney**, followed by poetry/music; **The Source 7.45 p.m.** Evening event honouring Thurles-born poet, the late **Dennis O'Driscoll**. **Sun. 11am, Stanwix Village:** Heritage walk. **2pm, Monks Pub:** Open mic. **All welcome.**

NEWLY BAPTISED: *John William Butler, Rahealty. *Alfie Tom Miller Ryan, Mill Road.

RECENTLY DECEASED: †Paddy Kelly, Leugh.

SAFEGUARDING MONTH IS OCTOBER: CREATING A SAFE PARISH:

A safe parish is one where children and young people are cherished, listened to and protected. Our safeguarding policies, training and procedures help us to provide safe environments for everyone involved in parish activities. We are grateful to our Parish Safeguarding Representatives, clergy, staff and volunteers for their continued commitment to this important work.

Please note Safeguarding Representatives will speak at the following Masses next weekend, October 17th/18th: Cathedral: Saturday Vigil Mass 7.00 p.m.; Bóthar na Naomh Church: Sunday 9.30 a.m. & 7.00 p.m.

"It cannot be emphasised enough how everything is interconnected. Just as the different aspects of the planet ----physical, chemical, are interrelated, so too living species are part of a network which we will never fully explore or understand." *Laudato Si*